



Federal Office
for Information Security

BSI TR-03185

Secure Software Lifecycle

Version 1.1.1



Document History

Table 1: BSI TR-03185 History

Version	Date	Editor	Description
1.1.1	2026-07-02	Mg, fvs, fd	- Merge BSI TR-03185(-1) v1.0 and BSI TR-03185-2 v1.1.0. - Reposition and slightly rephrase introduction. - Add section addressing AI based security scanning to introduction.

Table 2: BSI TR-03185-2 History

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Table 3: BSI TR-03185(-1) History

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1.0	2024-09-06		Version for initial publication

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0 Introduction

Secure software and hardware form the basis for secure use of IT products in governments, businesses and societies. The Federal Office for Information Security (BSI) therefore appeals to software producers to consider information security from the outset and to make it as easy as possible for users to use their products securely through secure pre-configuration.

Against this backdrop, this Technical Guideline (in German “Technische Richtlinie”, respectively TR as its acronym) was created in accordance with the requirements of the BSI IT-Grundschutz (IT basic protection) for secure software development processes, supplemented by the respective norms, standards and frameworks. The focus here was on the potential enhancement and structuring.

The European Union is also implementing the Cyber Resilience Act (CRA) to focus current legislation on the cybersecurity of IT products throughout their entire life cycle, thus placing manufacturers under an obligation to conduct the appropriate risk assessments and to maintain an adequate level of information security.

This TR comprises two parts: Part 1 addresses proprietary software, while part 2 addresses software that is generally referred to as “Open Source Software (OSS)” or “free / libre and open source software (FLOSS / FOSS)”.

0.1 Utilising Artificial Intelligence

This Technical Guideline (“Technische Richtlinie (TR)” in German) defines requirements for a secure software lifecycle, and the development processes and tools utilised for that. It is generally phrased without relying on specific technologies. If developers use code assistants, vulnerability scanners, Large Language Models (LLMs) or other AI based tools, in principle these are within the scope of this TR as “resources and tools used” (see section 1.1). AI based tools bear additional risks, e.g. due to their probabilistic properties. Such risks shall be considered and accordingly be taken into account, in order to ensure a secure software development process.

Due to the rapidly increasing capabilities of AI based tools and the opportunities they offer, BSI strongly recommends utilising such tools, especially AI based vulnerability scanners for software tests (see also section 1.3.2.4).

1 Secure Software Lifecycle for proprietary software

1.1 Objectives

Part 1 of this Technical Guideline

- lists and groups the requirements from existing norms and standards,
- provides an introduction to the topic of a secure software lifecycle,
- specifies the relevant requirements in the context of information security,
- provides the opportunity to evaluate and improve in-house development processes in terms of information security.

Part 1 of this Technical Guideline considers

- the processes in the context of software development and
- the resources and tools used.

1.2 Structure of Part 1 of this Technical Guideline

This chapter first outlines the TR system and the terms used within it. This is followed by the potential perspectives of the software user (Chapter 1.3.1) and the software producer (Chapter 1.3.2).

1.2.1 Definition of terms

Manufacturer

“Manufacturer” refers to a natural or legal person who (regardless of the organizational form or of the process model used) is responsible for producing software, i.e. developing, creating, delivering/providing and supporting such software.

Perspectives

The perspective from which a manufacturer operates in the software lifecycle may vary. The manufacturer’s perspectives are divided as follows:

- Software **user**

This includes processes, activities and requirements of the **software (tools) used** for production.

- Software **producer**

This refers to processes, activities and requirements for the **software to be produced**. This perspective includes that of the “software user” at all times.

Software lifecycle

Part 1 of this TR

refers to the software creation processes on the manufacturer side, from the perspective of software users and software producers (see below).

The process of defining requirements for the software to be created is not considered here. It is assumed that the relevant information security requirements are available or submitted to the manufacturer as a software producer.

Processes and requirements

Processes summarise the actions required to fulfil or implement the requirements for a secure software lifecycle and can be assigned to the perspectives.

Processes relating to the “software user” perspective:

- project management,
- documentation,
- testing and release,
- installation,
- patch and change management, and
- decommissioning.

Processes for the “software producer”:

- project management,
- documentation,
- development,
- testing and release,
- delivery,
- vulnerability management, and
- decommissioning.

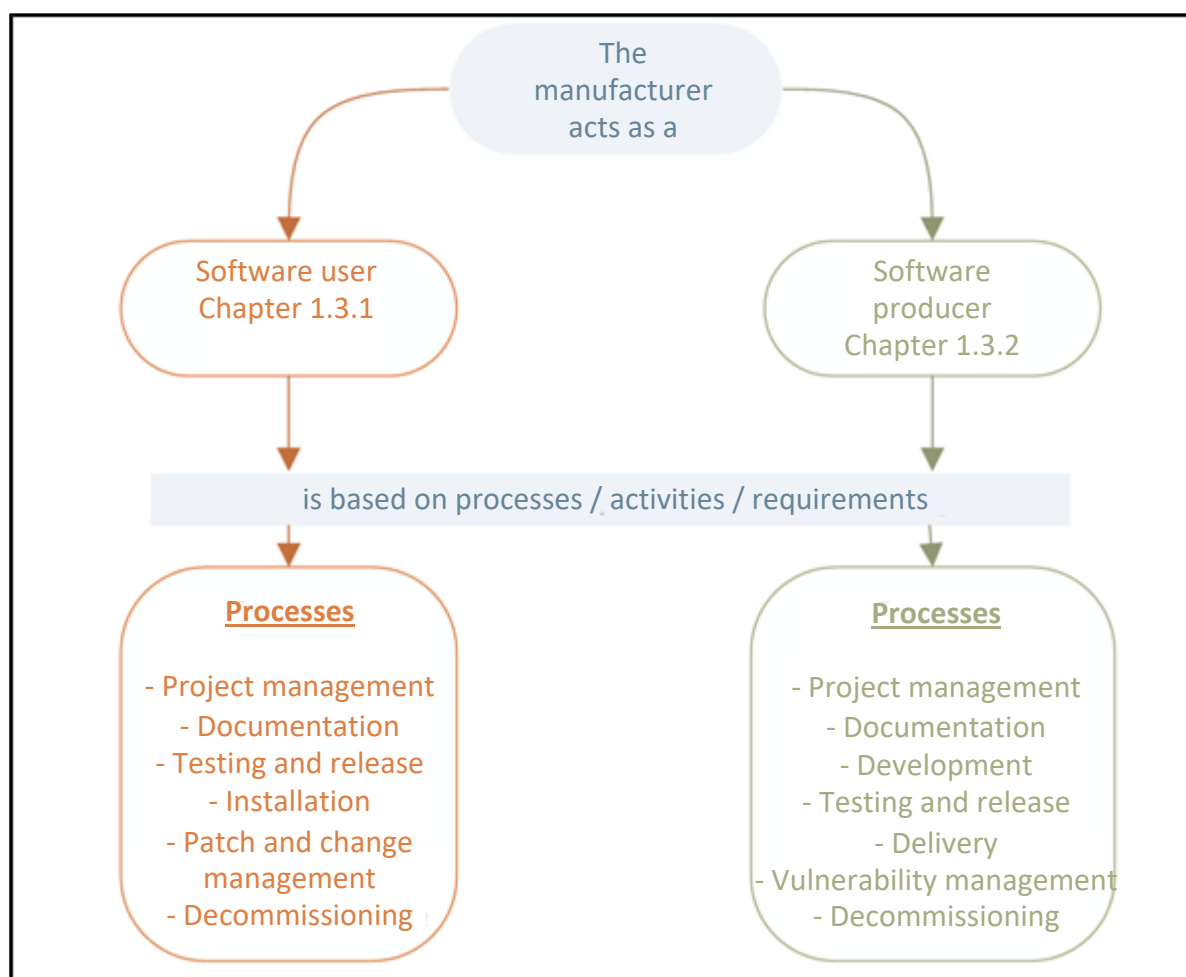


Figure 1: Perspectives and Processes of the Manufacturer

1.2.2 Notes and explanations

Information Security Management System (ISMS)

The information security issue relating to the provision of IT and infrastructure as a (supporting) task by the manufacturer should be taken into account within the framework of an information security concept or ISMS (e.g. pursuant to the BSI IT-Grundschutz). It does not form part of part 1 of this TR.

In the context of an ISMS, terms such as protection needs, security profile, trusted source are also used in this document and are assigned a specific meaning.

Project planning

The document focuses in particular on aspects of information security and does not constitute a guide for the planning of software projects.

Similarly, the order of the processes and requirements indicated here does not represent a mandatory chronological sequence for a software project.

Process model

Part 1 of this TR does not require a specific process model for software development, as the processes and methods described here are so generic that they can be adapted to the process model selected in the individual case (e.g. traditionally sequential or agile).

Modal verbs

In the requirements, the modal verbs “SHOULD” and “MUST” written in capital letters are used in their respective forms and the respective negations to make clear how the respective verbs should be interpreted. The definitions used here are based on [RFC2119] and DIN 820-2:2012, Annexe H [820-2].

MUST:	This term means that this is a requirement that must be imperatively fulfilled (absolute requirement).
MUST NOT:	This term means that something must not be done in any case (absolute prohibition).
SHOULD:	This term means that a requirement usually must be fulfilled, but that there can be reasons to not fulfil the requirement. However, this must be carefully assessed and well founded.
SHOULD NOT:	This term means that something should not be done usually, but that there can be reasons to do it. However, this must be carefully assessed and well founded.
MAY:	This expression denotes a requirement that is optional. The requirements indicated in the document should be considered as examples.

1.3 Requirements on the part of the manufacturer

The following chapters list the requirements on the part of the software manufacturer. These were compiled from various norms, standards and frameworks with reference to the BSI IT-Grundschutz-Kompodium, so the requirements may therefore exhibit different language styles and levels of detail.

All the requirements in the following two chapters (perspectives) are relevant for manufacturers. This arises from the assumption that it is not possible to produce software without IT support. The potential extent of tool support may vary greatly.

The sources used are referenced in the requirements listed for further information. The basis for this:

- BSI IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium 2023,
- NESAS, FS.16, Version 2.3,
- DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1:2018-10,
- NIST SP 800-218, Version 1.1, February 2022.

In addition to the source information, further information on the requirements is available based on the following system:

Table 4: System of Requirements

Requirement ID	Abbreviation of the respective requirement
Additional information	Sources of further information
Keywords	Important terms used in the text of the requirement
Glossary	Terms explained in the glossary

1.3.1 Requirements for the manufacturer as a user of software

This chapter lists the requirements for the manufacturer from the perspective of a software user. This specifically refers to tools that support the software lifecycle (e.g. for project management, documentation, development, testing, CI/CD), which are used in particular in the processes described in Chapter 1.3.2.

The requirements are broken down into:

- project management (General, acquisition, IT operations and personnel),
- documentation,
- testing and release,
- installation,
- patch and change management, and
- decommissioning.

1.3.1.1 Project management

Project management is essential for the use of tools to support the software lifecycle. Aspects of information security should also be noted here. The relevant requirements are divided into the sub-areas: general, acquisition, IT operations and personnel.

1.3.1.1.1 General

General considerations regarding the definition of the requirements for the software tools form the basis for the further process regarding the use of tools. The relevant requirements are listed below.

Table 5: Requirements User Project Management General

Requirement ID	Requirement
USER.PM.A.1	Before an institution introduces (new) software tools, it MUST decide and SHOULD document: • what the software tools are used for and what information (with the respective protection needs¹) will be processed with them,

¹ These protection needs may differ from the protection needs of the software to be created for subsequent use.

Requirement ID	Requirement
	• how users should be involved in requirements gathering and what support they should receive during implementation, • how the software tools are linked to other applications and IT systems and through which interfaces, • on which IT systems the software tools will be executed and the resources required to execute the software tools, and • whether the institution is now dependent on a manufacturer if it uses such software tools. Security aspects MUST be also considered here.
USER.PM.A.2	Based on the planning results, the requirements for the software tools MUST be documented in a requirements catalogue. The requirements catalogue MUST include the basic functional requirements. In addition, the non-functional requirements, and in particular the security requirements, MUST be included in the requirements catalogue. The requirements of both the business owners and the IT Operations department MUST be taken into account.
USER.PM.A.3	The legal requirements arising from the context of the data to be processed MUST also be taken into account.
USER.PM.A.4	The institution SHOULD consider the following security requirements in the requirements catalogue for the software tools: • The software tools SHOULD include general security features such as encryption, logging and authentication that are required in the application context. • The software tools SHOULD enable the hardening capabilities of the operating environment to be used. In particular, the hardening functions of the planned operating system and/or the anticipated execution environment SHOULD be considered (e.g. closing any ports that are not required, setting user permissions to a minimum). • If the software tools use (cryptographic) certificates, they SHOULD offer the option to display the certificates in a transparent manner. Moreover, it SHOULD be possible to block certificates, remove trusted certificates or add proprietary certificates. • The functions of the software tools arising from the security requirements SHOULD be used in the software operation.
USER.PM.A.5	The final requirements catalogue SHOULD be coordinated with all the relevant departments.
USER.PM.A.6	A verification² of the existing security functions MAY be considered or be useful for the tools used. The companies that manufacture the tools MAY be required to fulfil the appropriate requirements regarding the security of their tools.

² Verifications are e.g. audits or certifications.

Requirement ID	Requirement
	NOTE: Additional requirements exist in the context of planning for the following processes • installation, • testing and release, • patch and change management, and • decommissioning.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Modules APP.6, CON.8 NIST SP 800-218, Chapter PO
Keywords	Requirements catalogue, protection needs
Glossary	Business owner

1.3.1.1.2 Acquisition

The acquisition of software tools is another aspect of project management. The relevant requirements are listed below.

Table 6: Requirements User Project Management Acquisition

Requirement ID	Requirement
USER.PM.B.1	The software tools available on the market SHOULD be reviewed based on the requirements catalogue. They SHOULD be compared using an assessment scale. The next step SHOULD be to ascertain if the software tools selected fulfil the requirements of the institution. If several software tools are available, user acceptance and the additional effort for training or migration, for example, SHOULD also be considered. The responsible business owners SHOULD select a suitable software tool with the IT operations department based on the assessments and test results.
USER.PM.B.2	When purchasing software tools, the appropriate software MUST be selected based on the requirements catalogue. The software tool selected MUST be acquired from a trusted source.³ The trusted source SHOULD provide a method of verifying the integrity of the software tool. Furthermore, the software tool SHOULD be acquired with an appropriate maintenance contract or a comparable commitment from the manufacturer or software provider. These contracts or commitments SHOULD, in particular, guarantee that any vulnerabilities arising in the software tools will be promptly fixed throughout the entire period of use.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module APP.6
Keywords	Acquisition

³ Each institution should review and determine which internal, external sources (e.g. manufacturer's download site or original installation media) may be considered to be trustworthy. The individual protection needs should be taken into account (ISMS).

Requirement ID	Requirement
Glossary	-

1.3.1.1.3 IT Operations

When planning, requirements in the context of the operation of software tools must also be considered. The relevant requirements are listed below.

Table 7: Requirements User Project Management IT Operations

Requirement ID	Requirement
USER.PM.C.1	The institution SHOULD define mandatory regulations and summarise in a document how the software tools should be used and operated. All the relevant responsible persons, officers and employees of the institution SHOULD be aware of the document, which should form the basis for their work and actions. The document SHOULD also include a user manual that explains how to (securely) use and administer the software tools. Regular, random checks SHOULD be carried out to ensure that employees are complying with the stipulations in the document. The document SHOULD be updated regularly.
USER.PM.C.2	The types of software tools that are integrated into tool chains and how they are interconnected MUST be determined.
USER.PM.C.3	The distribution, operation and maintenance of tools SHOULD be carried out in accordance with the state of the art.
USER.PM.C.4	Only essential plug-ins and expansions SHOULD be installed. If expansions are used, the software tool SHOULD offer the possibility to configure and disable extensions.
USER.PM.C.5	The software product to be developed MUST be protected in terms of confidentiality, availability and integrity during the development cycle from design and implementation to release and delivery.
USER.PM.C.6	Private keys for the code signature MUST be specifically protected to prevent any unauthorised access or modification.
USER.PM.C.7	A regular security audit of the software development environment and the software test environment MAY be considered.
USER.PM.C.8	Regular testing of the integrity of the development environment using state-of-the-art cryptographic mechanisms MAY be useful. The checksum files and the check program itself SHOULD be adequately protected to prevent tampering. Important indications of a loss of integrity SHOULD not be buried under numerous irrelevant warnings (false positives).
USER.PM.C.9	Environments (e.g. development, build, test environment) SHOULD be operated separately from each other.
USER.PM.C.10	All access points (e.g. user accounts) for developers, testers, designers, etc. in the project MUST be hardened and secured.

Requirement ID	Requirement
Additional information	DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, Chapter 5 (SM) NIST SP 800-218, Chapter PO, PS IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium APP.6
Keywords	Development environment, documentation, integrity, user manual, tool chain
Glossary	-

1.3.1.1.4 Personnel

The clarification of responsibilities and roles and, where applicable, other requirements in terms of personnel are also important in the context of the use of software development tools. The following lists the relevant terms in the context of Project management – Personnel.

Table 8: Requirements User Project Management Personnel

Requirement ID	Requirement
USER.PM.D.1	The institution MUST clarify and define the responsibilities for technical support, release and operational administration well in advance. Responsibilities MUST be documented and updated as required.
USER.PM.D.2	A person responsible for information security MUST be appointed.
USER.PM.D.3	All employees MUST be notified of the responsibilities defined, notably what they are responsible for and the respective duties they will perform.
USER.PM.D.4	The tasks, roles and functions required SHOULD be structured in such a way that incompatible tasks such as operational and control functions are distributed among different individuals. A separation of duties SHOULD be defined and documented for incompatible functions. Representatives MUST also be subject to the separation of duties.
USER.PM.D.5	Employees MUST receive adequate training to perform their respective duties. Training sessions SHOULD be held at frequent intervals.
	NOTE: Additional requirements in the context of personnel are stipulated for the following processes: • testing and release, • patch and change management.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Modules APP.6, ORP.1, ORP.2, OPS.1.1.3, OPS.1.1.6
Keywords	Responsibilities, roles, documentation, training, separation of duties
Glossary	-

1.3.1.2 Documentation

When using software development tools, it is vital that any agreements and regulations are documented in writing. The requirements for documentation are listed below.

Table 9: Requirements User Documentation

Requirement ID	Requirement
USER.DOC.1	Documentation of any regulations agreed SHOULD be created and regularly updated.
Additional information	-
Keywords	Documentation
Glossary	-

1.3.1.3 Testing and release

Software tools are tested and released prior to installation and use. The relevant requirements are listed below.

Table 10: Requirements User Testing and Release

Requirement ID	Requirement
USER.TESTRELA.1	The framework conditions for software testing MUST be defined prior to the start of testing. The following MUST be considered: • Protection needs, organisational units, technical possibilities and test environments applicable within the institution. • Stipulations in the requirements catalogue. Any specification sheets (if available) MUST also be taken into account. • Selection of test cases such that they representatively check all the software functions specified in the requirements catalogue. Negative tests MUST also be taken into account. • The test environment must be selected to generally represent the manufacturer's IT infrastructure. Testing MUST be carried out to determine if the software is compatible and functional with the operating systems used in the existing configurations.
USER.TESTRELA.2	The following SHOULD be set out in writing: • the types of tests to be carried out, test cases and the anticipated results, • the release criteria, and • a procedure should a release be refused.
USER.TESTRELA.3	The following selection criteria SHOULD be applied when selecting software testers: • the software testers SHOULD have the professional qualifications required for the testing. • If software is tested at the source code level, the testers SHOULD have sufficient technical knowledge of the programming language to be tested and the development environment.
USER.TESTRELA.4	The business owners SHOULD inform the software testers regarding

Requirement ID	Requirement
	- the minimum types of tests to be performed and areas of the software to be tested, - the use cases and potential additional features of the software.
USER.TESTRELA.5	Should testers be required to access particularly sensitive information, it MAY make sense, for example, for the institution to obtain evidence of their integrity and reputation. The Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) SHOULD therefore involve the security officers or security representatives of the respective institution.
USER.TESTRELA.6	If production data that contains sensitive information is used for software testing, this test data MUST be appropriately protected. If such data contains personal information, it MUST be pseudonymized as a minimum requirement.
USER.TESTRELA.7	Software SHOULD only be tested in a designated test environment. The test environment SHOULD be operated separately from the production environment. The architectures and mechanisms used in the test environment SHOULD be documented. Procedures on how to manage the test environment after software testing is completed SHOULD be documented.
USER.TESTRELA.8	The software MUST be tested based on the framework conditions defined in the planning (see the requirements catalogue in USER.PM.A.2).
USER.TESTRELA.9	The installation of software tools SHOULD be checked in accordance with the regulations governing the installation and configuration of software. The installation and configuration documentation (if available) SHOULD also be checked.
USER.TESTRELA.10	Functional software tests MUST be used to check that all the software tool functions specified in the requirements catalogue are operating correctly. The functional software tests MUST be carried out in such a way that they do not affect productive operation.
USER.TESTRELA.11	Software tests MUST be performed to verify that all the essential non-functional requirements are fulfilled. In particular, security-specific software testing MUST be carried out if the software tool includes security-critical features.
USER.TESTRELA.12	Regression testing SHOULD be carried out if the software has been changed. Checks SHOULD be carried out to verify if the existing security mechanisms and settings have been unintentionally changed by the update. Full regression testing SHOULD be carried out and should also include expansions and aids. Any test cases omitted SHOULD be justified and documented.
USER.TESTRELA.13	Penetration testing as a testing method MAY be considered for the tools. A penetration testing concept SHOULD be created. The penetration testing concept SHOULD document the success criteria and the test methods that will be used. Penetration testing SHOULD be carried out in accordance with the framework conditions of the penetration testing concept.

Requirement ID	Requirement
	The security vulnerabilities revealed by penetration testing SHOULD be classified and documented.
USER.TESTRELA.14	The results of the software testing MUST be evaluated and documented. A target-actual comparison SHOULD be carried out with defined specifications.
USER.TESTRELA.15	The responsible organizational unit MUST verify whether the software tools have been tested in accordance with the requirements. The results of the software testing MUST align with the predefined expectations. Compliance with the legal and organizational requirements MUST also be checked.
USER.TESTRELA.16	The responsible organizational unit MUST release the software tools once the software testing has been carried out successfully. The release MUST be documented.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompodium, Module OPS.1.1.6
Keywords	Testing, release, regression testing, penetration testing, production data, test environment
Glossary	-

1.3.1.4 Installation

The following requirements are relevant when installing tools.

Table 11: Requirements User Installation

Requirement ID	Requirement
USER.INST.1	The installation and configuration of the software tools and associated components MUST be regulated and documented by IT Operations (e.g. manual and/or automatic installation). It should be noted that:
USER.INST.2	The integrity of the “installation files” is checked before installation
USER.INST.3	Software tools may only be used with licenses that reflect the intended purpose and the contractual provisions
USER.INST.4	- The software tools are installed and operate only with the minimum necessary scope of functions - The software tools are executed with the minimum authorizations - Settings are configured with a minimal amount of data (with respect to the processing of personal data) - All the relevant security updates and patches are installed after a risk assessment before the software tools are used in production, and - The person authorized to install the software and the manner in which it is installed is determined in consultation with the person responsible for the subject matter.
USER.INST.5	Only unmodified versions of the released software tools may be used.

Requirement ID	Requirement
USER.INST.6	The availability of the installation and configuration files is ensured even after installation.
USER.INST.7	Software tools MUST be installed in accordance with the current regulations.
USER.INST.8	An up-to-date inventory SHOULD document the systems on which the software tools are used and under which license. The security-relevant settings SHOULD also be documented. The inventory SHOULD be structured in such a way that it will be possible to conduct a quick overview with the necessary details (e. g. SBOM) in the event of a security incident.
USER.INST.9	Tools MUST be configured to also provide the predefined (meta) data regarding the task carried out. These will serve as measured values and help ascertain the effectiveness of the tools.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module APP.6 NIST SP 800-218, Chapter PO
Keywords	Inventory, license, installation
Glossary	-

1.3.1.5 Patch and change management

A patch from a software tool may be used to fix bugs/vulnerabilities.

Required changes to software tools are managed in a change management process.

Table 12: Requirements User Patch and Change Management

Requirement ID	Requirement
USER.PATCH.A.1	Responsibilities for patch and change management MUST be defined. These must be documented in the role concept (see "Personnel").
USER.PATCH.A.2	If any IT components, software tools or configuration data are changed, the specifications MUST also consider the security aspects. These MUST be documented and traced in a patch and change management document. In general, it MUST be ensured that the level of security is maintained during and after the changes. In particular, the required security settings SHOULD be retained.
USER.PATCH.A.3	The patch and change management document MUST indicate how to handle integrated update mechanisms (auto-update) of the software used. In particular, the security and appropriate configuration of these mechanisms MUST be determined. New components SHOULD also be tested to see what update mechanisms they contain.
USER.PATCH.A.4	The authenticity and integrity of software packages SHOULD be ensured during the entire patch or change process.

Requirement ID	Requirement
USER.PATCH.A.5	All patches and changes MUST be planned, approved and documented in an appropriate manner.
USER.PATCH.A.6	Patches and changes SHOULD be appropriately tested in advance (see also the Chapter Testing and release).
USER.PATCH.A.7	Fallback solutions MUST be implemented if patches are installed and changes are applied.
USER.PATCH.A.8	The CISO MUST be involved in any changes that may affect information security.
USER.PATCH.A.9	It SHOULD be determined for devices that are temporarily or permanently unavailable how such devices receive patches and changes.
USER.PATCH.A.10	All change requests (CR/request for changes/RfCs) SHOULD be recorded and documented and checked by the business owner to ensure that sufficient consideration has been given to aspects of information security.
USER.PATCH.A.11	The coordination process relating to changes SHOULD take into account all the relevant target groups and the impact on information security. The target groups affected by the change SHOULD be able to provide evidence of their view of the matter. A defined process SHOULD also be established to speed up major change requests.
USER.PATCH.A.12	The change management process SHOULD be integrated into the business processes or specialist/departmental tasks. The current situation of the business processes affected SHOULD be considered when implementing planned changes. All the relevant departments SHOULD be notified of any imminent changes. An escalation level SHOULD also be established.
USER.PATCH.A.13	Checks SHOULD be carried out to ascertain if a change was successful. The results of any subsequent testing SHOULD be documented.
USER.PATCH.A.14	Changes SHOULD be documented in all phases, applications and systems. The appropriate regulations SHOULD be developed for this purpose.
USER.PATCH.A.15	IT systems and software tools SHOULD be updated regularly. Patches SHOULD essentially be applied promptly after release. The following aspects have to be noted here: • Patches MUST be evaluated promptly after release and prioritised accordingly in accordance with the patch and change management concept. For the evaluation, a check SHOULD be carried out to ascertain whether any known vulnerabilities exist for this patch. • A decision MUST be taken whether to apply the patch: • If a patch is applied, checks SHOULD be carried out to ascertain if it was successfully applied promptly to all the relevant systems. • If a patch is not applied, the decision and reasons MUST be documented. If software tools will be used that are no longer supported by the manufacturer or for which support is no longer available, the secure operation of such tools in future MUST be checked. If this is not the case, such software tools MUST cease to be used.

Requirement ID	Requirement
USER.PATCH.A.1 6	If tools are used for patch and change management, information security-specific policies SHOULD be documented as mandatory obligations.
USER.PATCH.A.1 7	Breakpoints at which the execution of a change containing a bug is paused at a specific point MAY be defined when using patch and change management tools.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module OPS.1.1.3
Keywords	Patch, change management
Glossary	-

1.3.1.6 Decommissioning

The management of software that is no longer used must be regulated, and any decommissioning must be carried out in a controlled process.

Table 13: Requirements User Decommissioning

Requirement ID	Requirement
USER.DECOM.1	When software tools are decommissioned, the detailed process for this SHOULD be regulated. A procedure SHOULD also be implemented on how users are notified of this. Clarification SHOULD be provided regarding whether the functional requirements continue to exist (e.g. for processing specialist tasks). If so, the way in which the required functions of the respective software tools will continue to be available SHOULD be regulated.
USER.DECOM.2	If software tools are uninstalled in accordance with the decommissioning regulations: - Any files that have been created and are no longer required MUST be removed. - All the entries in the system files that were carried out for the product and are no longer required MUST be reversed.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module APP.6
Keywords	Decommissioning, deinstallation
Glossary	-

1.3.2 Requirements for the manufacturer as a software producer

This chapter sets out the obligations to the manufacturer from the perspective of a producer of software.

The chapter is divided into the following topics

- project management (general, personnel),
- documentation (project documentation, user documentation),
- development (development management, design, threat modelling, design/architecture, design review, in-development testing, third-party components, code management, tools, inventory),

- testing and release (patches and updates),
- delivery,
- vulnerability management, and
- decommissioning.

NOTE: The process of defining requirements for the software to be created is not currently considered here. It is assumed that the relevant information security requirements are currently available or are being provided.

1.3.2.1 Project management

Information security aspects are vitally important when planning software development. The focus for the manufacturer is therefore on the requirements for the product, the company's organization, the processes and, where applicable, the manufacturer's technical infrastructure.

1.3.2.1.1 General

The following sets out the general aspects of software development and requirements regarding information security.

Table 14: Requirements Producer Project Management General

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.PM.A.1	All the information security requirements for the software development infrastructure and processes MUST be identified, documented and known at the start of the project and then constantly updated.
PROD.PM.A.2	All the information security requirements for the software to be developed MUST be identified, documented and known at the start of the project and then constantly updated.
PROD.PM.A.3	A procedure MUST exist for every development project that analyses the information security requirements for the product and the product environment to ensure they are: • current, comprehensible and valid, and • consistent with the results of threat modelling. This process MUST involve • developers commissioned with the implementation, • independent testers, • clients, and • persons responsible for the information security of the project.
PROD.PM.A.4	Appropriate quality objectives SHOULD be defined for the development project.
PROD.PM.A.5	A suitable process model for software development (including maintenance) MUST be defined. A schedule for software development MUST be created based on the process model selected. The requirements for information security for the procedure MUST be integrated into the process model.
PROD.PM.A.6	An appropriate risk management system SHOULD be defined for the process model.

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.PM.A.7	Strict compliance MUST be observed with the selected process model, including the specified information security requirements.
PROD.PM.A.8	When developing software, an appropriate control or project management model SHOULD be used based on the process model selected. When selecting the control/project management model, specific attention SHOULD be paid to the required qualifications of the personnel and the coverage of all the relevant phases during the lifecycle of the software.
PROD.PM.A.9	Documentation on software development guidelines SHOULD be created and updated. The documentation on software development specifications SHOULD include naming conventions and specifications on elements that should or should not be used. Documentation on software development specifications SHOULD be binding for the developers.
PROD.PM.A.10	The control or project management model SHOULD be integrated into the binding documentation for software development.
PROD.PM.A.11	A project versioning tool MUST be used to identify and monitor decisions, changes and their responsibilities.
PROD.PM.A.12	A process MUST be established to document and manage all the requirements and design changes throughout the development and software lifecycle.
PROD.PM.A.13	The manufacturer MUST define the protection needs for product information (e.g. vulnerabilities, keys for signing) for the entire software lifecycle and implement the appropriate safeguards for the information requiring protection.
PROD.PM.A.14	A procedure MUST be implemented to document the successful completion of all the security-related activities for the product prior to the release of the product.
PROD.PM.A.15	All the processes in the software lifecycle MUST be subjected to a process review (quality management) to ensure continuous improvement.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module CON.8 NESAS, Chapter [REQ-GEN] DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, Chapter 5 (SM), 6 (SR), 10 (DM) NIST SP 800-218, Chapter PO, RV
Keywords	Project management, process model, information security requirements, documentation, process review, improvement, quality management
Glossary	Process model

1.3.2.1.2 Personnel

The importance of information security for an institution and its business processes must be transparent and comprehensible for all the persons involved. The following specifies the definition of roles and responsibilities in the software development process.

Table 15: Requirements Producer Project Management Personnel

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.PM.C.1	A person SHOULD be appointed who has overall responsibility for the software development process. Roles and responsibilities for all software development activities SHOULD also be defined. The roles SHOULD cover the following topics: • requirements (requirements engineering) and change management, • software design and architecture, • information security in the software development, • software implementation in the areas relevant to the development project, and • software testing. The person responsible for information security SHOULD be appointed for each development project.
PROD.PM.C.2	The tasks, roles and functions required SHOULD be structured in such a way that incompatible tasks such as operational and control functions are distributed among different individuals. A separation of duties SHOULD be defined and documented for incompatible functions. Representatives MUST also be subject to the separation of duties.
PROD.PM.C.3	Responsibilities MUST be agreed with management and communicated to the persons responsible.
PROD.PM.C.4	Roles and responsibilities MUST be regularly evaluated and modified where necessary.
PROD.PM.C.5	The developers and the other members of the development team SHOULD be trained in aspects of general information security and in the areas that are specifically relevant to them: • requirements analysis, • project management in general and software development specifically, • risk management or threat modelling in software development, • quality management and quality assurance, • models, methods and best practices for software development, • software architecture, • software testing, • change management, and • information security, security requirements within the institution and security aspects in specific areas.
PROD.PM.C.6	The training courses carried out and the results of such SHOULD be documented.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Modules CON.8, ORP.1 DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, Chapter 5 (SM)

Requirement ID	Requirement
	NIST SP 800-218, Chapter PO NESAS, Chapter [REQ-GEN]
Keywords	Training, roles, documentation, separation of duties
Glossary	-

1.3.2.2 Documentation

The documentation to be maintained in a (development) project may be divided into project documentation and user documentation. The project documentation should contain all the elements that enable the traceability of decisions and the evidence of results in the project (software creation).

This must be distinguished from the user documentation, which contains all the important information about the software for future users.

The following two tables list the requirements in these two areas.

1.3.2.2.1 Project documentation

Table 16: Requirements Producer Project Documentation

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DOC.A.1	Adequate project, functional and interface documentation SHOULD be created and updated. Software development SHOULD be documented in such a way that experts can use the documentation to understand and develop the program code. The documentation SHOULD also include the software architecture and threat modelling. The aspects of the documentation SHOULD be considered in the software development process model.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module CON.8
Keywords	Documentation, project documentation
Glossary	-

1.3.2.2.2 User documentation

Table 17: Requirements Producer User Documentation

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DOC.B.1	User documentation MUST be created that contains specific security instructions for installation and configuration (keyword: security by default) for admins, and for the use of the product/software for the user.
PROD.DOC.B.2	The user documentation MUST describe the product security strategy and list the guaranteed product features.

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DOC.B.3	The documentation MUST contain information on the requirements stipulated by the application environment (relating to the product security strategy, defence in depth).
PROD.DOC.B.4	Specific instructions and guidance for hardening, installation and maintenance of the product MUST be created and documented.
PROD.DOC.B.5	In terms of product use, requirements and recommendations regarding the management of user accounts MUST be made and documented if the product has capacity for user accounts.
PROD.DOC.B.6	The user documentation MUST refer to the software version delivered and MUST be current, accurate and complete.
	NOTE: The following processes may require changes/adaptations to the user documentation: • development, • testing and release, • vulnerability management, and • decommissioning.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module CON.8 DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, Chapter 12 (SG) NESAS, Chapter [REQ-REL]
Keywords	Documentation, user documentation
Glossary	Layered security strategy/defence-in-depth strategy

1.3.2.3 Development

The implementation of the project begins with development; the basis for which are the requirements specified for the software during the analysis. The implementation of threat modelling is an important aspect. The third-party components used, the tools and the associated testing during development play a crucial role in the implementation of the program code.

The requirements listed below can help avoid technical debt.

1.3.2.3.1 Development management

A general set of rules defines the basic requirements/framework conditions for all participants.

Table 18: Requirements Producer Development Management

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DEV.A.1	In particular, the information security requirements, risks and related design decisions for the software to be created MUST be monitored and maintained.
PROD.DEV.A.2	Available software components SHOULD be used if they meet the information security requirements specified.

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DEV.A.3	The software component SHOULD be created in-house only if no existing, developed software component is appropriate. The creation of such software SHOULD observe the instructions in this document.
PROD.DEV.A.4	Mandatory documented specifications regarding coding standards MUST be fulfilled and periodically reviewed and updated. The specifications MUST include as a minimum: • no use of constructs for which information security issues are known or anticipated, • the use of automated tools and configurations, • secure programming techniques, • testing of the inputs (if the trust boundary is exceeded), and • error/exception handling in the source code.
PROD.DEV.A.5	The software SHOULD be developed so that “secure” settings are pre-set (security by default). These settings MUST be documented.
Additional information	NIST SP 800-218, Chapter PW DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, Chapter 8 (SI)
Keywords	Coding standards, security by default, documentation
Glossary	Error handling, trust boundary

1.3.2.3.2 Design

The design determines how software can be created from the specified requirements analysis (requirements catalogue / requirements). The information security requirements in this process are listed here.

Table 19: Requirements Producer Development Design

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DEV.B.1	The software design SHOULD consider the requirements catalogue (see Chapter 1.3.2 NOTE), the security profile (protection needs of data and functions) and the results of the threat modelling (see chapter 1.3.2.3.3).
PROD.DEV.B.2	Decisions relating to architecture and design SHOULD be made based on secure design principles (see PROD.DEV.B.4) and observed and maintained throughout the software lifecycle (security by design).
PROD.DEV.B.3	A secure design MUST be created for each product interface. This MUST contain: • communication via the interface (e.g. data/control flows) • safeguarding measures, and • objects affected by attacks. The following SHOULD be observed:

Requirement ID	Requirement
	• A note whether the interface is accessible from the outside (from other products) or from the inside (from other product components), or both; • Information security impact of the product's information security environment on the external interface • Potential users of the interface and the protected objects that can be accessed through it (directly or indirectly) • A determination of if access to the interface crosses a trust boundary • IT security considerations, assumptions and/or conditions relating to the use of the interface within the IT security environment of the product, including applicable threats • The IT security roles, authorizations/rights and access authorizations required to use the interface and to access the aforementioned protected objects • The IT security capabilities and/or compensation mechanisms to protect the interface and the aforementioned protected objects, including the validation of both inputs and outputs and error handling • The use of third-party products to implement the interface and the capabilities of such with respect to IT security • Documentation that describes how to use the interface when it is accessible from outside, and • A description of how the design mitigates the threats identified in the threat model.
PROD.DEV.B.4	The software design MUST be carried out in accordance with secure design principles (in terms of information security), in particular: • input validation of data, preferably on the server, • least privilege, • security by default, • protection of data in the event of bugs and failures, • protection of data confidentiality, • the use of trustworthy procedures and implementations to protect data and metadata, including user authentication, • security-relevant events must be logged in a process that can be evaluated, • information/comments relevant to the development SHOULD be removed from the production version, • reduction of the attack surface, • ability to manage errors and exceptions, and • privacy by design.
PROD.DEV.B.5	Where possible, support SHOULD be provided for the use of standardized security functions and services (e.g. access control systems) via the appropriate interfaces.

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DEV.B.6	The system design MUST be documented.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module CON.8 DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, Chapter 7 (SD) NESAS, Chapter [REQ-DES] NIST SP 800-218, Chapter PW
Keywords	Security by design, security by default
Glossary	Privacy by design

1.3.2.3.3 Threat modelling

Threat modelling is used to analyse the product to be developed with respect to potential threats. It is the basis for all the security-relevant aspects in subsequent activities in the development process.

Table 20: Requirements Producer Development Threat Modelling

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DEV.C.1	Threat modelling MUST be performed during the design phase of the software development. Potential threats SHOULD therefore be identified based on the security profile, security catalogue and the planned deployment environment or deployment scenario. Threats SHOULD be assessed in terms of their likelihood of occurrence and impact.
PROD.DEV.C.2	The threat model MUST consider the following aspects (where applicable): • the data flows of sensitive information, • trust boundaries, • processes, • data storage, • interaction with external components or systems on which the IT security of the product relies, • internal and external communication protocols implemented in the product, • debug interfaces, • potential threats and their severity as determined by a vulnerability assessment system (e. g. CVSS), • mitigation measures and/or management of any threat, • security-related issues identified, and • external dependencies in the form of drivers or third-party applications (code not developed by the manufacturer) that are linked to the application/product.

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DEV.C.3	The threat model MUST be reviewed by the development team for correctness and comprehensibility.
PROD.DEV.C.4	The threat model MUST be reviewed and updated regularly or occasion-related for products in use and must be state-of-the-art at all times.
PROD.DEV.C.5	All the threat modelling results/findings MUST be evaluated and addressed.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module CON.8 DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, Chapter 6 (SR) NESAS, Chapter [REQ-DES] NIST SP 800-218, Chapter PW
Keywords	Threat model, security profile
Glossary	Security profile

1.3.2.3.4 Design – software architecture

The structures of the future software system are defined in the software architecture as part of the software design. This serves as the basis for the further process steps in which the architecture can be adapted.

Table 21: Requirements Producer Development Design

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DEV.D.1	A secure software architecture SHOULD be developed as part of secure software design.
PROD.DEV.D.2	Secure software architecture principles MUST be used (security by design), e.g. domain separation, encapsulation, layering.
PROD.DEV.D.3	Layering MUST be implemented based on risk assessment and considering the threat model, if available. Each layer MUST provide an information security mechanism/instance.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module CON.8 NESAS, Chapter [REQ-DES] DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, Chapter 7 (SD)
Keywords	Domain separation, encapsulation, layering, security by design
Glossary	Defence in depth, domain separation, encapsulation, layering

1.3.2.3.5 Design review

Here, the design is tested for compliance with the information security requirements.

Table 22: Requirements Producer Development Design Review

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DEV.E.1	The design MUST be reviewed to ensure that all the specified security requirements for the system design have been fulfilled. These include: - the naming of the security requirements that the design considers sufficient and insufficient, - the consideration of threats and how they use the existing interfaces, - the documentation of the extent to which proven design principles (see “Design” above) were not observed.
PROD.DEV.E.3	The design MUST be reviewed by an individual not involved in the design and/or by automated tools.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module CON.8 NIST SP 800-218, Chapter PW DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, Chapter 7 (SD)
Keywords	Design, review, test
Glossary	-

1.3.2.3.6 Development-related testing

Development-related testing is carried out during the implementation to detect bugs in the implementation (code) as early as possible.

Table 23: Requirements Producer Development-related testing

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DEV.F.1	The basis for the development-related testing MUST be the documentation defined for binding specifications.
PROD.DEV.F.2	Software testing MUST be carried out during development and the source code, among others, must be checked for bugs (e.g. using a code review). The business owners of the client or commissioning department SHOULD be involved in this process. The development-related tests MUST include - the functional and non-functional requirements of the software - and must also cover negative testing. - Additionally, check all the critical limits of the input and data types, - identify non-observed coding standards, and - ascertain to what extent the implementation is adequately protected against the threats. Test data SHOULD be carefully selected and protected. Moreover, an automatic static code analysis SHOULD be performed. The software MUST be tested in a test and development environment that is separate from the production environment. In addition, testing MUST be

Requirement ID	Requirement
	carried out to evaluate if the system requirements for the intended software are sufficient.
PROD.DEV.F.3	Findings from development-related testing MUST be documented and monitored.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module CON.8 NESAS, Chapter [REQ-IMP] NIST SP 800-218, Chapter PW DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, Chapter 8 (SI)
Keywords	Code review, static and dynamic code analysis, documentation, test data
Glossary	-

1.3.2.3.7 Third-party components

Using third-party components enables the use of previously implemented functionalities from external and internal sources; however, this involves additional risk. Components may be frameworks, middleware, libraries, modules, etc.

Table 24: Requirements Producer Development Third-party Components

Requirement ID	Requirement
	The following aspects must be considered when using third-party components:
PROD.DEV.G.1	They MUST originate from a trustworthy source⁴.
PROD.DEV.G.2	Their integrity of the sources MUST be ensured by checksums or cryptographic certificates before use.
PROD.DEV.G.3	- Information security risks MUST be identified and addressed (keyword: secure supply chain). - Unknown external components (or program libraries) the security of which cannot be assured by established and recognised peer reviews or similar MUST be checked for vulnerabilities. - All external components MUST be checked for potential conflicts.
PROD.DEV.G.4	They MUST comply with the development cycle requirements of this document if they are commissioned and affect information security.
PROD.DEV.G.5	They MUST fulfil the manufacturer's information security requirements throughout their lifecycle.
PROD.DEV.G.6	Outdated versions of third-party components SHOULD NOT be used.
PROD.DEV.G.7	Third-party components that are no longer maintained SHOULD NOT be used.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module CON.8 NESAS, Chapter [REQ-GEN]

⁴) Each institution should check and determine which internal and external sources (e.g. manufacturer's download page or original installation media) are considered trustworthy. The individual protection needs should be taken into account (ISMS).

Requirement ID	Requirement
	NIST SP 800-218, Chapter PW, PO DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, Chapter 5 (SM)
Keywords	Third-party components, integrity, secure supply chain
Glossary	-

1.3.2.3.8 Code management

Code management is used to manage the program code.

Table 25: Requirements Producer Development Code Management

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DEV.H.1	The source code of the development project MUST be managed using an appropriate version control system. The following aspects in particular must be considered: • Access to the version control MUST be regulated and defined. • It MUST be specified when changes to the source code should be saved as a separate version in the version control system. • All changes MUST be traceable and reversible. • Version management including data MUST be part of a data backup concept and MUST NOT be carried out without data backup.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module CON.8 NESAS, Chapter [REQ-IMP] NIST SP 800-218, Chapter PS
Keywords	Version control, source code, data backup
Glossary	-

1.3.2.3.9 Compiler, interpreter and build tools

Within the framework of software development, tools are used to support the development process at different points. Requirements for tools in the implementation context are presented as follows.

Table 26: Requirements Producer Compiler, Interpreter and Build Tools

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DEV.I.1	Tools (compiler, interpreter and build tools) MUST be used that provide features to improve the information security of the code to be produced.
PROD.DEV.I.2	The potential of the tools used to improve information security MUST be implemented and exploited.
PROD.DEV.I.3	The manufacturer MUST use an automated build tool to create reproducible builds and store the build logs.
PROD.DEV.I.4	Any data used in the build environment to generate a build MUST originate from a VCS (version control system).

Requirement ID	Requirement
	This guarantees reproducibility.
Additional information	NIST SP 800-218, Chapter PW NESAS, Chapter [REQ-BUI]
Keywords	Tools, version control
Glossary	Build tool

1.3.2.3.10 Inventory

An inventory is used to log the components of a software and associated information.

Table 27: Requirements Producer Development Inventory

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DEV.L.1	The essential files and information (e.g. integrity-assuring information and information on the origin of any external components used) MUST be securely archived for every software release.
PROD.DEV.L.2	A proof of origin of components used MUST be compiled and made available to third parties in accordance with the manufacturer's policy/compliance (e.g. in the form of a SBOM).
Additional information	NIST SP 800-218, Chapter PS BSI TR-03183
Keywords	Archiving, SBOM
Glossary	SBOM

1.3.2.4 Testing and release

In this process, the software created is finally tested with a view to release. The following requirements must be taken into account here.

Table 28: Requirements Producer Development Testing and Release

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.TEST.A.1	The framework conditions for software testing MUST be defined prior to the start of testing. The following MUST be considered: • Protection needs, organisational units, technical possibilities and test environments applicable within the institution. • Stipulations in the requirements catalogue. Any specification sheets (if available) MUST also be considered. • Selection of test cases such that they representatively check all the software functions specified in the requirements catalogue. Negative tests MUST also be considered. • The tests MUST include checking for known vulnerabilities.

	The test environment must be selected to generally cover the IT infrastructure in the specified operational environment.
PROD.TEST.A.2	The information security requirements and the threat model (see chapter 1.3.2.3.3) MUST be taken into account when deciding which information security-related tests should be carried out.
PROD.TEST.A.3	The following SHOULD be specified in writing: - the anticipated test results, - release criteria, - a procedure if a release is rejected.
PROD.TEST.A.4	The following selection criteria SHOULD be applied when selecting software testers: - The software testers SHOULD have the professional qualifications required for the testing. - If software is tested at the source code level, the testers SHOULD have sufficient technical knowledge of the programming language to be tested and the development environment.
PROD.TEST.A.5	The roles “developer” and “tester” SHOULD be separated in terms of personnel.
PROD.TEST.A.6	The business owner SHOULD inform the software testers regarding - the minimum types of tests to be performed and areas of the software to be tested, and - the use cases and potential additional features of the software.
PROD.TEST.A.7	Should testers be required to access particularly sensitive information, it MAY make sense, for example, for the institution to obtain evidence of their integrity and reputation. The Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) SHOULD therefore involve the security officers or security representatives of the respective institution.
PROD.TEST.A.8	The developed software MUST be tested based on the framework conditions defined in the planning.
PROD.TEST.A.9	Any test cases omitted SHOULD be justified and documented.
PROD.TEST.A.10	If production data that contains sensitive information is used for software testing, this test data MUST be appropriately protected. If such data contains personal information, it MUST be pseudonymised as a minimum requirement.
PROD.TEST.A.11	The developed software SHOULD only be tested in a designated test environment. The test environment SHOULD be operated separately from the production environment. The architectures and mechanisms used in the test environment SHOULD be documented. Procedures on how to manage the test environment after software testing is completed SHOULD be documented.

PROD.TEST.A.12	The installation of the created software SHOULD be checked in accordance with the regulations governing installation and configuration. The installation and configuration documentation SHOULD also be checked.
PROD.TEST.A.13	Functional software tests MUST verify that all the software is operating fully and correctly.
PROD.TEST.A.14	Software tests MUST be performed to verify that all the essential non-functional requirements are fulfilled. In particular, security-specific software testing MUST be carried out if the software tool includes security-critical features.
PROD.TEST.A.15	Penetration testing SHOULD be carried out for developed software as a test method based on the defined concept. The penetration testing concept SHOULD document the success criteria and the test methods that will be used. The vulnerabilities discovered by penetration testing SHOULD be classified and documented.
PROD.TEST.A.16	The results of the software testing MUST be evaluated and documented. A target-actual comparison SHOULD be carried out with defined specifications.
PROD.TEST.A.17	The responsible organisational unit MUST ascertain whether the software has been tested in accordance with the requirements, and release the software as soon as: • The software tests have been carried out successfully* (*for software testing to be successful, the results MUST match the pre-defined expectations), and • All the security-related issues have been conclusively addressed. The release MUST be documented.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module OPS.1.1.6 DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, Chapter 5 (SM) and Chapter 9 (SVV) NIST SP 800-218, Chapter PW NESAS, Chapter [REQ-TES]
Keywords	Test, negative test, release, documentation, threat model, test environment, role separation, qualification, penetration testing
Glossary	-

1.3.2.4.1 Patches and updates

Table 29: Requirements Producer Testing and Release for Patches and Updates

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.TEST.D.1	Regression testing SHOULD be carried out if the software has been changed. Checks SHOULD be carried out to verify if the existing security mechanisms and settings have been unintentionally changed by the update. Regression testing SHOULD be carried out in full and should also include expansions (e.g. plug-ins, add-ons) and tools (e.g. maintenance routines).

PROD.TEST.D.2	Regression testing covers updates from the manufacturer, updates to third-party components in the product, and updates to other components or platforms on which the product relies. A verification SHOULD also be carried out to ascertain if the application of the update does not conflict with any other constraints or restrictions.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module OPS.1.1.6 DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, Chapter 11 (SUM)
Keywords	Update, test, regression testing
Glossary	Update

1.3.2.5 Delivery

Tested and released software (new builds and updates/patches) can be provided/delivered.

Table 30: Requirements Producer Delivery

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.REL.1	The manufacturer MUST provide a mechanism to ensure integrity (e.g. checksums, digital signatures) for the delivery of software.
PROD.REL.2	Each software release MUST be assigned to a specific build version with a unique version number.
	NOTE: Additional questions arise, particularly in the context of the delivery of patches, which are discussed further in the “vulnerability management” process.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module CON.8 DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, Chapter 5 (SM) NESAS, Chapter [REQ-REL] NIST SP 800-218, Chapter PS
Keywords	Integrity assurance, delivery, version number
Glossary	-

1.3.2.6 Vulnerability management

Bugs may appear in (software) products that cause security problems arising from vulnerabilities.

Solutions (e.g. patches/updates) must be provided promptly if security-critical vulnerabilities are identified in the software developed in-house.

If solutions to security-critical vulnerabilities in third-party components are provided by the manufacturers/creators of such, it may be necessary to adapt the software developed in-house accordingly and made available as a solution in a timely manner.

This describes requirements for addressing security-related issues in a product.

Table 31: Requirements Producer Vulnerability Management

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.FIX.A.1	In addition to the existing documentation, documentation MUST be created that defines time windows for the provision of IT security updates (e.g. promptly). Provision includes the qualification for achievement of the target and delivery. The following must be taken into account as a minimum: • potential impact of the vulnerability, • public knowledge of the vulnerability, • whether exploits have been published for the vulnerability, • the scope of the products used that are affected and the availability of effective mitigations instead of a patch. A distinction SHOULD be made between the delivery channels for normal updates and IT security updates. Compliance MUST be ensured with the aspects specified in the documentation.
PROD.FIX.A.2	When vulnerabilities become known, the product MUST be tested for similar/comparable vulnerabilities to address them in a proactive manner, rather than merely reacting to external reports of vulnerabilities.
PROD.FIX.A.3	A reporting point for information security-related issues with the product MUST be created and communicated to the relevant persons. A procedure MUST be implemented to ensure that reports (from internal and external sources) are monitored/processed.
PROD.FIX.A.4	Active research and appropriate actions MUST be carried out to ensure that security-critical vulnerabilities already detected the company's proprietary product and in libraries/software used by third-party providers are noted (e.g. in-house research). Proprietary software MUST be tested for its susceptibility to such vulnerabilities.
PROD.FIX.A.5	Proprietary products MUST be tested for potentially undiscovered security-critical vulnerabilities. The causes of such must be detected and observed over time for potential patterns (e.g. non-compliance with binding coding requirements).
PROD.FIX.A.6	Any information security-related issues reported MUST be investigated in a timely manner⁵ and in a process to be defined to ascertain: • applicability for the product, • verifiability, and • threats that trigger the problem.
PROD.FIX.A.7	An analysis of information security-related issues in the product MUST be carried out in a process to be defined, with a focus on:

⁵ The timeliness/prompt processing will be determined by market conditions.

Requirement ID	Requirement
	- the evaluation of their impact on: - the actual IT security environment in which they were detected, - the IT security environment of the product, and - the layered security strategy of the product; - definition of the severity as determined by a vulnerability assessment system (e.g. CVSS), - identification of all products/product versions also affected by the security-related issue, - identification of the root cause of the problem and other IT security-related issues.
PROD.FIX.A.8	Information security-related issues MUST be addressed/managed using a specific process. Based on the analysis, a decision MUST be taken as to whether the issue should reported/disclosed⁶. An acceptable residual risk level MUST be established that will be achieved when managing the problem. Potential ways of fixing the issue include the following: - fix (patch/code change), - creation of a plan to fix the issue, - move to a future solution/version, or - a decision to not fix the problem if the residual risk appears acceptable. The following MUST apply: - other (relevant) procedures must be notified of the problem. This applies to the actual product and other products. - third-party providers will be notified if the issues affect their embedded source code. If the issues are resolved, recommendations SHOULD be made to avoid future problems. The process MUST include a periodic review (during each release or iteration cycle as a minimum) of known/open safety-related issues.
PROD.FIX.A.9	A procedure MUST be implemented to ensure that information security-related issues in the product that must be reported and the solution proposed by the manufacturer (correction, remedial plan, postponement to a future solution, non-correction) are available to users in a timely manner⁷. The process SHOULD include coordination of the procedure with the (third-party component) manufacturer regarding the disclosure of issues in third-party components.
PROD.FIX.A.10	Documentation on IT security updates for the product MUST be made available to users, including, but not limited to, the following:

⁶ Solutions that should be reported typically relate to released products where the severity of the issue is considered sufficiently high to be reported/disclosed by the manufacturer.

⁷ The timeliness/prompt processing will be determined by market conditions

Requirement ID	Requirement
	- the version number(s) of the product to which the patch applies, - instructions on how to apply patches manually or using an automated process, - a description of any impact the patch will have on the product, including a reboot, - instructions on how to verify that a patch has been applied, and - risks arising from the fact that the patch is not being used or not being released by the developer.
PROD.FIX.A.11	Documentation on IT security updates for dependent components or operating systems MUST be made available to users, including information on - Whether the product is compatible with the IT security update for the dependent component or operating system, and - If IT security updates are not approved by the product provider, the mitigation measures that will be applied if the update is not implemented.
Additional information	IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium, Module CON.8 DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, Chapter 10 (DM) and 11 (SUM) NESAS, Chapter [REQ OPE] NIST SP 800-218, Chapter RV BSI TR-03191 CSAF CVD-Prozess, Leitlinie des BSI (CVD process, BSI guideline)
Keywords	Delivery channels, IT security update, solution, reporting centre, patch, vulnerability
Glossary	IT security update, solution, patch, vulnerability

1.3.2.7 Decommissioning

The information security aspects must also be considered if a software product is discontinued and is no longer supported by the manufacturer.

Table 32: Requirements Producer Decommissioning

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DECOM.1	The decommissioning of the product or related regulations MUST be described in the user documentation. This must contain instructions on how to uninstall the software and remove the data used/stored.
PROD.DECOM.2	Users SHOULD be notified of the discontinuation of the software and the date on which the manufacturer will withdraw support. Users SHOULD be notified of potential migration paths.

Requirement ID	Requirement
PROD.DECOM.3	The development tools used for the product SHOULD be cleaned/tidied up. For example, all access rights to product information (source code, scripts, design documents, catalogue, etc.) that are no longer required SHOULD be withdrawn.
Additional information	DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, Chapter 12 (SG)
Keywords	User documentation, decommissioning
Glossary	-

2 Secure Software Lifecycle for Open Source Software

2.1 Introduction

Secure software is essential for the use of IT products in governments, businesses and societies. The German Federal Office for Information Security (BSI) appeals to all relevant stakeholders to consider information security from the outset and to ease estimating a software component's security posture as far as possible in order to enable its secure use.

This part 2 "Secure Software Lifecycle for Open Source Software", or "Secure OSS Lifecycle" for short, of the Technical Guideline BSI TR-03185 complements part 1, which solely addresses the lifecycle of proprietary software products. Due to the fundamental differences in roles, the development process proper, and because of the intrinsic properties of Open Source Software licenses (as defined by FSF⁸, DFSG⁹ and OSI¹⁰; see also SPDX¹¹ and openCode¹²), a "Secure Software Lifecycle" modelled for proprietary software does not fit. Hence this part 2 was developed which focusses specifically on "Open Source Software (OSS)", also known as "Free / Libre and Open Source Software (FLOSS / FOSS)".

The European Union (EU) legislated the Cyber Resilience Act (CRA) to ensure cybersecurity of IT products throughout their entire lifecycle by obligating manufacturers and Open Source Software stewards to conduct appropriate risk assessments and to maintain an adequate level of information security for their software products etc. (i.e. "products with digital elements").

2.1.1 Objectives

Part 2 of this Technical Guideline

- is based on well recognized guidelines and frameworks (see section 3),
- is agnostic of tooling, development processes and available resources, and
- aims to be minimal and avoids placing additional burden on developers and project maintainers.

Part 2 of this Technical Guideline is intended to not contradict (in the sense of "to be compatible with")

- EU Cyber Resilience Act (CRA), and
- BSI IT-Grundschutz (IT basic protection).

2.2 Structure of Part 2 of this Technical Guideline

This chapter outlines the methodology of part 2 of this Technical Guideline and the terms used.

⁸ <http://www.gnu.org/philosophy/free-sw.en.html#fs-definition>;

German translation: <http://www.gnu.org/philosophy/free-sw.de.html#fs-definition>

⁹ <https://wiki.debian.org/DebianFreeSoftwareGuidelines>;

German translation (unauthorized): https://de.wikipedia.org/wiki/Debian_Free_Software_Guidelines

¹⁰ <https://opensource.org/osd>;

German translation (unauthorized):

https://de.wikipedia.org/wiki/Open_Source_Initiative#Definition_von_Open_Source

¹¹ <https://spdx.org/licenses/>

¹² <https://opencode.de/de/wissen/rechtssichere-nutzung/open-source-lizenzen>

2.2.1 Requirements Language

In the requirements, the modal verbs “SHOULD” and “MUST” written in capital letters are used in their respective forms and the respective negations to make clear how the respective verbs should be interpreted. The definitions used here are based on RFC2119 and DIN 820-2 :2020, Annex H.

Table 33: Modal verbs

Verb	Definition
MUST	This term means that this is a requirement that must be imperatively fulfilled (absolute requirement).
MUST NOT	This term means that something must not be done in any case (absolute prohibition).
SHOULD	This term means that a requirement usually must be fulfilled, but that there can be reasons to not fulfil the requirement. However, this must be carefully assessed and well founded.
SHOULD NOT	This term means that something should not be done usually, but that there can be reasons to do it. However, this must be carefully assessed and well founded.
MAY	This expression denotes a requirement that is optional.

2.2.2 Definition of Terms

Table 34: Definition of terms

Term	Definition
Manufacturer	A natural or legal person who develops or manufactures products with digital elements or has products with digital elements designed, developed or manufactured, and markets them under its name or trademark, whether for payment, monetization or free of charge.
Steward	A legal person, other than a manufacturer, that has the purpose or objective of systematically providing support on a sustained basis for the development of specific products with digital elements, qualifying as Free and Open Source Software (FOSS) and intended for commercial activities, and that ensures the viability of those products.
Maintainer	A person responsible for managing and overseeing a software project, including but not limited to writing code, reviewing contributions and ensuring the project’s quality and direction.
Contributor	A person (acting as independent or on behalf of an organization) who participates in the development of a software project by providing code, documentation, bug reports, or other forms of support.
Upstream	Refers to a repository/organization where a software project originates from and where most of the development takes place.
Downstream	A repository/organization other than upstream, where a software is enhanced, built, distributed or integrated.

2.2.3 Methodology

As outlined before, one goal of part 2 of this Technical Guideline is to improve the security of software generally referred to as “Open Source Software (OSS)” or “Free / Libre and Open Source Software (FLOSS / FOSS)” without putting unnecessary burden on maintainers and contributors. In many OSS projects, additional work to comply with sophisticated security guidelines (such as creating and maintaining

specialised documentation) will take away time that could be spent in applying practical security measures such as looking for and fixing vulnerabilities. Security incidents such as the backdoor in xz-utils or flaws in curl or OpenSSL (“Heartbleed”) show that there is a delicate balance to be met in order to successfully raise software security in environments with very little available resources. Hence this Technical Guideline does not appoint a specific party or role responsible for making and keeping an OSS project compliant to this Technical Guideline. In accordance with the CRA, this provides several options for who may implement these requirements (in order of preference):

1. Manufacturers or stewards depending on a software component within the scope of this guideline, should become involved in the “upstream” development to raise the software security of these components at their source.
2. Upstream project maintainers may choose to implement these requirements, likely motivated to raise the software security of their project.
3. Manufacturers or stewards of products depending on a software component within the scope of this guideline may maintain a “downstream” fork and implement these requirements there.

2.3 Requirements

The requirements in this section have been compiled from or are based on the following guidelines, guidance and frameworks:

- BSI IT-Grundschutz (ITG), Kompendium 2023
https://www.bsi.bund.de/DE/Themen/Unternehmen-und-Organisationen/Standards-und-Zertifizierung/IT-Grundschutz/IT-Grundschutz-Kompendium/it-grundschutz-kompendium_node.html
- BSI TR-03185: Secure Software Lifecycle (TR), Version 1.0
<https://www.bsi.bund.de/dok/TR-03185-en>
- Cyber Resilience Act (CRA), 2024/2847
<https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2024/2847/oj>
- Open Chain (OC, ISO/IEC 18974), Edition 1, 2023
<https://openchainproject.org/security-assurance>
- Open CRE (OCRE), unversioned, visited May 2025
https://opencre.org/root_cres
- OpenSSF Security Baseline (OSPS), Version 2025-02-25
<https://baseline.openssf.org/versions/2025-02-25>
- Secure Software Development Framework (SSDF, NIST SP 800-218), February 2022
<https://csrc.nist.gov/pubs/sp/800/218/final>
- Supply-chain Levels for Software Artifacts (SLSA), Version 1.1
<https://slsa.dev/spec/v1.1/>

The term “Induced by” in the rightmost column of the following tables expresses the fact that the requirements in this Technical Guideline are neither directly derived from nor equivalent to the linked references. Deep-links are provided where technically feasible. Readers may refer to these links to assist in guiding and informing implementation or contextual understanding of the Requirement. Furthermore, all text indicated as “Note” is non-normative.

2.3.1 Governance (GV)

Table 35: Governance requirements

ID	Requirement	Induced by
GV.01	Information on how to contribute to the project MUST be documented. Information about the expected quality of contributions SHOULD be given.	- OC: 4.1.2 OSPS-GV-03
GV.02	The project's repository, websites and sensitive data MUST be protected against unauthorized actions.	OSPS-AC-01 - CRA: Annex I, Part I, No. (2)(d-f) - SSDF: PS.1.1

2.3.2 Legal (LE)

Table 36: Legal requirements

ID	Requirement	Induced by
LE.01	A license MUST be stated for all content made available by the project, including the project's documentation.	OSPS-LE-02
LE.02	A copy of all licenses in use, or references hereto, MUST be provided.	OSPS-LE-03

2.3.3 Quality (QA)

Table 37: Quality requirements

ID	Requirement	Induced by
QA.01	A list of third-party components used in the software MUST be available.	OSPS-QA-02, OSPS-DO-06 - OCRE: 863-521
QA.02	All project's source code MUST be publicly readable.	OSPS-QA-01
QA.03	The project MUST inform how to report defects.	OSPS-DO-02, OSPS-GV-02 - CRA: Annex II, No. 2
QA.04	Procedures for testing MUST be implemented and utilised. Note: This can include, among others, a CI/CD pipeline for automated testing or a test harness for testing locally.	OSPS-GV-03, OSPS-QA-06
QA.05	The project SHOULD take measures to reduce or avoid memory safety issues. Note: This can include additional instructions for memory safety in the contributions guide.	OSPS-GV-03, OSPS-QA-06 - SSDF: PW.5.1, PW.6.1, PW.6.2
QA.06	All changes to the source code SHOULD be peer-reviewed.	OSPS-AC-03 - SSDF: PW.2.1

2.3.4 Build and Release (BR)

Table 38: Requirements for building and releasing software

ID	Requirement	Induced by
BR.01	Information on how to build all software assets MUST be publicly available.	OSPS-DO-01, OSPS-DO-03 SLSA 1.1 Build L1

<i>ID</i>	<i>Requirement</i>	<i>Induced by</i>
BR.02	All releases and released software assets that are intended for use MUST be assigned unique, monotonically increasing version identifiers. Note: The version identifier must be unique, incrementally increased, and convey the context of the release as compared to past releases, e.g., within a specific branch.	• OSPS-BR-02 • CRA: Annex I, Part I, No. (2)(f)
BR.03	All assets MUST be distributed in a way that maintains integrity or, at least, allows the verification thereof. Means to maintain and verify the authenticity of the distributed assets MAY be deployed.	• OSPS-DO-03, OSPS-BR-03, OSPS-BR-06 • CRA: Annex I, Part I, No. (2)(d-f, i-k)
BR.04	All releases MUST provide a descriptive log of functional and security modifications.	• OSPS-BR-04 • CRA: Annex I, Part I, No. (2)(l); Annex I, Part II, No. 4; Annex II, No. 8(b)
BR.05	Released source packages MUST NOT contain any content that is not present in the project's repository or cannot be deterministically generated from that repository.	• OSPS-QA-05
BR.06	Builds SHOULD be reproducible.	• SLSA 1.1 Build L1

2.3.5 Vulnerability Management (VM)

Table 39: Requirements for vulnerability management

<i>ID</i>	<i>Requirement</i>	<i>Induced by</i>
VM.01	The project documentation MUST contain security contacts for reporting vulnerabilities. There SHOULD be a way to do that privately.	• OSPS-VM-01, OSPS-VM-02, OSPS-VM-03 • CRA: Annex I, Part I, No. (2)(c); Annex I, Part II, No. (5-7); Annex II, No. (1-3)
VM.02	The project MUST publish information about discovered vulnerabilities within a reasonable period of time.	• CRA: Annex I, Part II, No. (1, 4, 6) • OSPS-VM-04

2.3.6 Decommissioning (DE)

Table 40: Requirements for the decommissioning of software

<i>ID</i>	<i>Requirement</i>	<i>Induced by</i>
DE.01	The discontinuation of the project itself, parts of it, or specific versions or version ranges SHOULD be communicated adequately.	• TR: PROD.DECOM.2 • OSPS-DO-04, OSPS-DO-05
DE.02	Migration paths MAY be outlined.	• TR: PROD.DECOM.2

Glossary

Definitions in quotation marks are either taken directly from or are compatible with (i.e. less specific than) those provided by the OpenSSF Security Baseline: <https://baseline.openssf.org/versions/2025-02-25#lexicon>.

Table 41: Glossary

Term	Explanation
Build tool	A program that automatically generates software. Source: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Build_automation#Tools
Business owner	Business owners are responsible for the content of one or more business or specialist processes. Source: BSI Grundschrift-Kompendium, 2023
Change	“Any alteration of the project's codebase, ... or documentation. This may include addition, deletion, or modification of content.”
Defect	“Errors or flaws in the software that cause it to produce incorrect or unintended results, or to behave in an unintended way. Defects can include bugs, vulnerabilities, or other issues that impact the software's functionality or security. Defects may have originally been intentional, but a change in environment or understanding has made them undesirable.”
Domain separation	Domain: a collection of data and instructions Domain separation: the separation of domains enables control to be exerted over the access to and use of such collections. Source: https://mlhale.github.io/nebraska-gencyber-modules/intro_to_first_principles/README/
Encapsulation	Data encapsulation in programming terms refers to “hiding” data or information from external access. No direct access to the internal data structure is possible, and access is exclusively via defined interfaces (black box model). Source: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Encapsulation_(computer_programming)
Error handling	Provisions in the source code that are implemented during development to adequately manage errors and messages that are reported back to the “program” “from outside” during runtime.
FLOSS	Free, libre, open source software; see BSI website
IT security update	A solution prepared for delivery, the sum of the measures from the manufacturer's perspective that are provided to users to fix a vulnerability. The decision to fix the issue always involves a code change (patch).
Layered security strategy/defence-in-depth strategy	Approach to protecting the system against any specific attacks by implementing several independent methods Source: DIN EN IEC 62443-4-1, no. 3.1.15
Layering	In programming terms, layering is the organisation of programming into separate functional components that interact in a sequential and hierarchical manner, whereby each layer typically has a single interface to the layer above and below it.
License	“A legal document that defines the terms under which the software can be used, modified, and distributed.”
Patch	A patch is a bug fix for executable programs; it can also contain minor functional extensions. A patch generally contains a code change, including any essential information (e.g. documentation, configuration file). Source: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Patch_(computing)

Term	Explanation
Privacy by design	While “privacy by design” primarily refers to the protection of privacy and thus is primarily designed to ensure that specific data processing simply does not occur, “data protection by design” also includes data processing that actually takes place and is legitimate. Source: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Privacy_by_design
Process model	Process models (e.g. waterfall model, V-model, agile development) stipulate specified action steps and the sequence of such to structure and plan the software development process. Source: IT-Grundschutz-Kompodium, Module CON.8: Software Development
Project Documentation	“Written materials related to the project, such as user guides, developer guides, and contribution guidelines. These documents help users and developers understand, contribute to, and interact with the software. At release time, this may include provenance information, licensing details, and other metadata.”
Protection needs	The protection needs of an object with respect to the basic values considered (e.g. availability, integrity, confidentiality) is based on the severity of the damage that could be caused if the basic values are violated. The protection needs cannot be quantified.
Release	“(verb) The process of making a bundle of assets available to users [with the intention of it being used]” “(noun) A bundle ... of code, documentation, and other assets made available to users [with the intention of it being used].”
Released Software Asset	“Deliverables provided to users as part of a release.”
Repository	“A storage location, [often] managed by a version control system, where the project's code, documentation, and other resources are stored. It [may] track changes, manage collaborator permissions, and include configuration options such [as for] ... access controls.”
SBOM	Software bill of materials, software parts list: A “software bill of materials” (SBOM) is a machine-processable file that contains supply chain relationships and details of the components used in a software product. It assists the automatic processing of information regarding software components. This includes both the “primary component” and any (third-party) components used. Source: BSI TR-03183-2, see https://www.bsi.bund.de/dok/TR-03183
Security profile	Protection needs of data and functions regarding confidentiality, integrity and availability.
Solution (to the vulnerability)	Approach/(bundle of) measures from the manufacturer's perspective to address an accepted vulnerability. May differ from the solution anticipated by the customer.
Technical debt	Costs for additional remedial work arising from implementing a quick solution as opposed to an effective one. Source: https://asana.com/de/resources/technical-debt
Trust boundary	A limit at which the data changes the trust level. Example: the receipt of data from an unverified source, e.g. user input or network broadcast. Source: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Trust_boundary
Version Identifier	“A label assigned to a specific release of the software Commonly recommended formats are Semantic Versioning or Calendar Versioning.”

Term	Explanation
Vulnerability	A vulnerability is a fault or bug in an IT system or institution relating to security. The origin may lie in the conception, algorithms used, implementation, configuration, operation and the organisation. A vulnerability may cause a threat to occur and therefore damage an institution or system. A vulnerability renders an object (an institution or system) vulnerable to threats.
Vulnerability Reporting	“The act of identifying and documenting exploitable vulnerabilities in released software assets. This may include privately or openly reporting vulnerabilities to maintainers, security teams, or the public, as well as tracking the resolution of these vulnerabilities.”

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